

TRUSTMRR DATASET • 1,000 STARTUPS

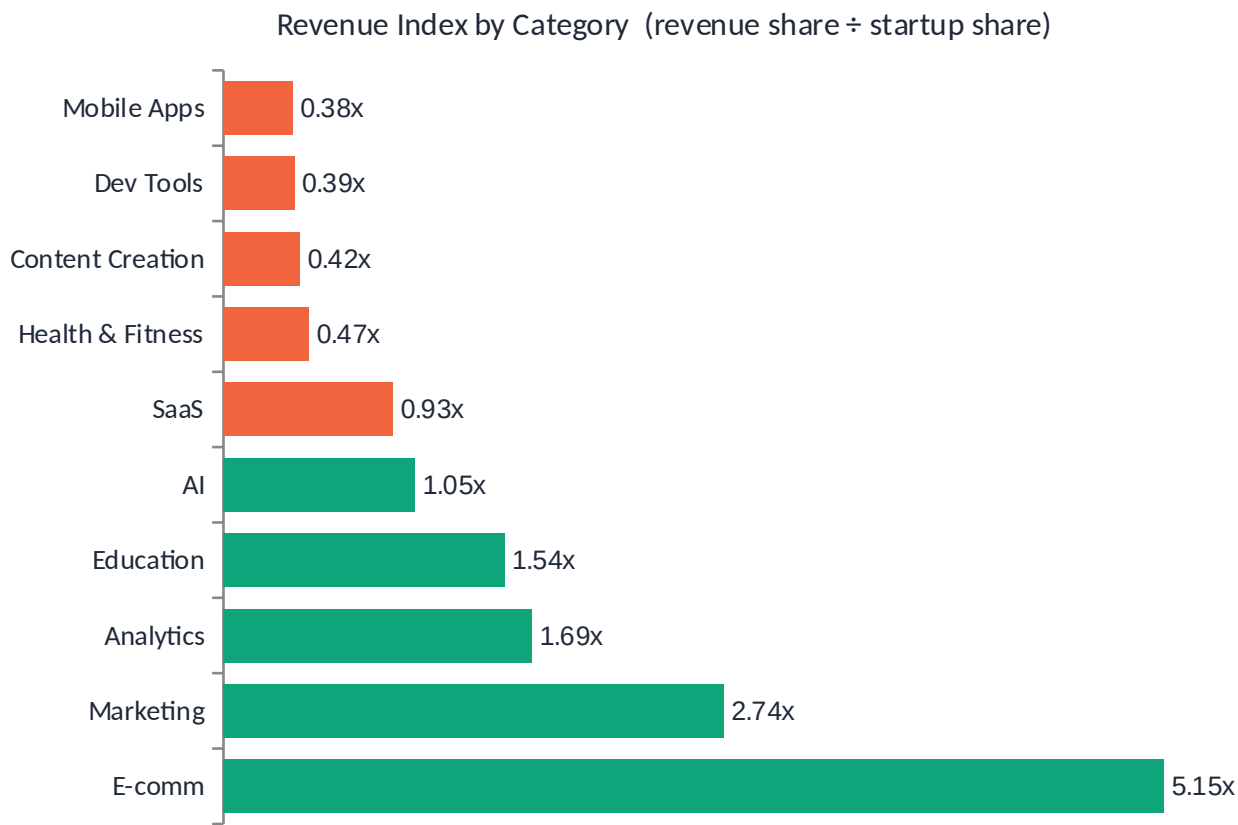
Where the Revenue Actually Lives

Three data-backed insights on category efficiency, marketplace economics,
and what actually predicts a startup's revenue — pulled from 1,000 live TrustMRR listings.

INSIGHT 01

A few categories punch far above their weight

E-commerce is only 2.6% of the 1,000 startups but pulls in 13.4% of total 30-day revenue — a 5.1x concentration. Mobile Apps and Dev Tools show the opposite: high headcount, low revenue share.



5.1x

E-commerce revenue index — top-performing category relative to its size

27%

Share of all 1,000 startups building in AI — the single largest category by volume

0.4x

Mobile Apps & Dev Tools revenue index — high founder interest, low revenue capture

Startups listed for sale are quietly the strongest performers

26% of the dataset (262 startups) is marked on_sale. Sellers appear to list once they have real traction — these businesses carry 5.6x higher median MRR than those not for sale.

262

of 1,000

Startups currently listed on the marketplace
(26.2%)

\$1,055

vs. \$187

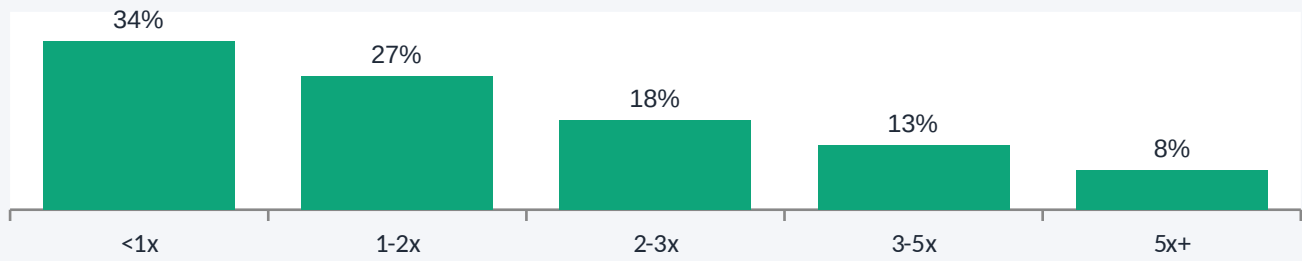
Median MRR of on-sale startups vs. those
not for sale

2.3x

monthly rev.

Median asking price is 2.3x monthly revenue
(typical deal benchmark)

Revenue-multiple deal distribution (on-sale startups)



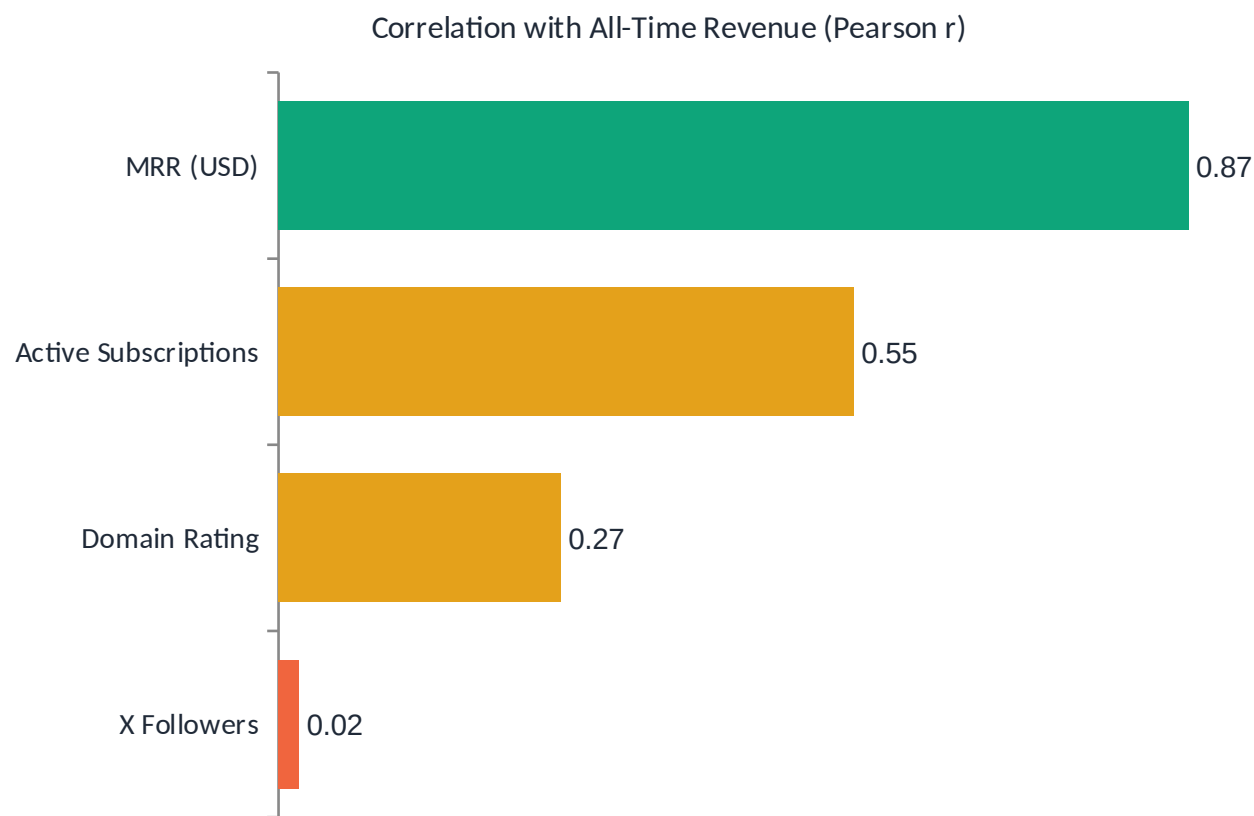
Takeaway

Most deals cluster under 2x revenue — well below typical SaaS acquisition multiples — signaling buyer caution or thin profit data on these micro-startups.

INSIGHT 03

Social following and domain authority barely predict revenue

Across all 1,000 startups, X (Twitter) followers show almost zero correlation with all-time revenue. Domain rating (an SEO authority score) is only weakly correlated. Neither is a reliable proxy for a healthy revenue business.



0.02

Correlation between X followers and all-time revenue — essentially no relationship

0.87

MRR is (unsurprisingly) the strongest predictor of all-time revenue — the fundamentals still matter most

Implication: don't underwrite a startup's revenue potential from its audience size or SEO score — ask for the MRR and subscription numbers directly.

SUMMARY

What this means going forward

01

Chase revenue-dense categories, not crowded ones

E-commerce and Marketing generate outsized revenue relative to founder headcount. AI has the volume, but the field is far more crowded per dollar earned.

02

Use marketplace listings as a signal, not just a shopping list

On-sale startups already screen for traction (5.6x higher median MRR). Median asking multiples of ~2.3x monthly revenue suggest realistic entry points for acquirers.

03

Diligence on fundamentals, not follower counts

Skip vanity-metric screening. Request MRR and active-subscription data directly — they explain revenue far better than social or SEO signals.